



INSTRUCTION DIVISION
FIRST SEMESTER 2026-27

Course Handout

Date: 3.08.2026

Course No. : BITS C484/GSF311
Course Title : Introduction to Conflict Management
Instructor-in-charge : MADHURIMA DAS
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Chamber no: 6168Q

1. Course description: Nature and dynamics of conflict; characteristics of conflict; theories of conflict; reasons and sources of conflict; value of conflict in social change; different approaches to addressing and managing conflict; conflict analysis through socio-economic class; class-based dimensions of conflict; culture and globalization perspectives; role of culture in propagating conflict; role of globalization in nation-state conflict; workplace and organizational conflict dynamics; conformity theories and conflict; power of communication; identity-based perspectives on conflict; AI, technology, and conflict resolution; algorithmic and digital dimensions of conflict; negotiation techniques; mitigation and resolution techniques; conflict management styles.

2. Scope and Objective of the Course:

To develop the knowledge and professional skills necessary to facilitate resolution of conflicts. Emphasis would be laid on skills and specific techniques to resolve inter-personal, organizational and community-based conflicts. At the conclusion of the course, the student will understand the basic dynamics of conflict, most significant interventions used to manage conflict, benefits and costs of conflict, recognize his or her preferred style of conflict management and develop an understanding and appreciation of the conflict management styles of others.

3. Course learning outcomes:

- Focus and familiarity with the theories and theorists in the conflict school of thought.
- Understanding of the basis of conflict in society from the lens of structures like socio-economic class.
- Understanding the debates around conflict from the standpoint of gender.
- Understanding conflict from the point of view of culture.
- Evaluating shaping of conflict from systems of globalization and ethnocentric tensions.
- Understanding conformity theories and their association with conflict.
- Understanding the power of communication and the development of self.
- Evaluating the power of communication with respect to conflict resolution.





- Understanding of negotiation strategies and conflict resolution.

4. Textbook:

Mayer Bernard (2000). The Dynamics of Conflict Resolution, San Francisco: Wiley Company.

Additional readings will be uploaded on Nalanda. Class slides/discussions and lectures are important.

5. Course Plan:

Wk no.	Lecture. No.	Learning Objectives	Topics to be covered	Ref. to Textbook Chapters	Learning Outcome
	1-9	To examine the relationship between gender, culture and conflict and to address the role of value system leading to social change.	Introduction to Conflict Management: An Overview • Nature and dynamics of conflict • Characteristics of conflict • Special focus on theories of Karl Marx and Max Weber • Reasons and sources of conflict • Value of conflict in social change • The different approaches to addressing and managing conflict.	Will be mentioned in lecture Class notes/discussions	
	10-15	To think about conflict from identity perspective: socio-economic class	Conflict analysis and socio-economic class • Conflict analysis through socio-economic class perspective • Why does class matter? • Class-based dimensions of conflict • Discuss the various kinds of conflict emerging out of class.	Will be mentioned in lecture Class notes/discussions	





16-29	To think about conflict from identity perspective: gender	Conflict analysis and gender. Discuss the dimensions of conflict with respect to gender. Gender theories and social construction of gender with reference to conflict	Will be mentioned in lecture Class notes/discussions	
28-34	To think about conflict from identity perspective: culture and globalization	Conflict analysis through culture and globalization. • Culture and globalization perspectives on conflict • Role of culture in propagating conflict • Discuss the ways through which culture propagates conflict • Role of globalization in nation state conflict	Will be mentioned in lecture Class notes/discussions	
37-40	To think about conformity and conflict, communication, the individual and conflict resolution	Conflict analysis and resolution. • Discuss the conformity theories and conflict. • Identity-based perspectives on conflict • Power of communication and • Workplace and organizational conflict dynamics • AI, technology and conflict resolution • Algorithmic and digital dimensions of conflict • Negotiation techniques • Mitigation and resolution techniques • Conflict management styles • Negotiation and conflict resolution.	Will be mentioned in lecture Class notes/discussions	





6. Evaluation Scheme:

EC No.	Evaluation Component	Duration	Weightage	Date, Time & Venue	Comments
1.	Assignment 1	-	15 Marks	--	
2.	Mid Semester Test	90 Minutes	30 Marks		
3.	Assignment 2	-	15 Marks	--	
4.	Comprehensive Examination	2/3 Hours	40 Marks	--	

7. Criterion for NC: [30% of the average of the top three performers or 40% of the median, whichever is lower.]

8. Attendance Policy: Each student is expected to attend all classes and participate in all evaluation components.

9. Chamber Consultation Hours: To be announced in class

10. Make-up Policy: Make-ups are not given as a routine. It is solely dependent upon the GENUINENESS of the circumstances under which a student fails to appear in a scheduled test.

Reading Assignment: Students will come prepared to the class after reading the topic on which lecture will be delivered in the class.

Course Notices: Notices, if any, concerning the course will be posted on Nalanda.

Any other item: Students are strongly advised to attend the classes regularly and take the tests on the scheduled dates.

Instructor-In-Charge
GS F311

